

Accessibility - Best Practices

When creating course content, following the practices below will help you address accessibility efficiently and effectively.

- When possible, build content directly in Canvas.
- Limit Canvas uploads to Word and PPTX when possible.
- Use pdf only when needed i.e.
 - the file size is more than 500MB
 - the tables must have merged or empty cells
 - maintaining layout of the document is imperative.
- When converting from Word to PDF, use the "Save as" feature to preserve accessibility.
- Avoid converting PowerPoints to PDF.
- When possible link to outside resources such as journal articles. Uploading them as pdfs in Canvas will require you to ensure their accessibility.
- Prioritize accessibility of frequently used documents.
- When remediating, if possible, start with the original version of the document.
- Use Canvas Studio for videos; it generates captions automatically which are ~85% accurate, so a review is still needed. You may contact TIDE to request captions.
- Always use the built-in accessibility checker (in office 365 products, PDF and Canvas) and perform manual checks. Note that an accessible word document does not always result in an accessible PDF.